Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy

St Eanswythe's C of E Primary School

Learning holistically through God's unconditional love

Vision: ***Rooted in Folkestone's vibrant seaside community, we at St Eanswythe's radiate God's unconditional love by being inclusive, accepting, and supportive. Inspired by Jesus' commandment, "Love one another as I have loved you," everyone is nurtured, enabling them to reach their full potential as caring, confident members of both our school family and global community. We provide a rich, holistic education through a range of academic, physical, creative, and spiritual experiences. Our shared aim is for every child to approach their future life with awe, wonder, and enthusiasm; flourishing as the individuals that God intends them to be.***

Date Approved: September 2026

Next Review Date: September 2027

Signed: Headteacher

Signed: Chair of Directors

Contents

1. Purpose, vision and safeguarding principles 3
2. Statutory framework, definitions and scope 3
    Definitions 3
3. Safeguarding contacts and reporting routes 4
4. Roles and responsibilities 4
    All staff and volunteers 4
    Designated Safeguarding Lead and deputies 5
    Headteacher 5
    Governing Body and safeguarding governor 5
5. Recognising abuse, neglect, exploitation and additional vulnerabilities 6
    Children who may be disproportionately vulnerable 6
6. Responding to concerns and disclosures 6
    Female genital mutilation 7
7. Family Help, referrals, multi-agency working and escalation 7
8. Child-on-child abuse, harmful sexual behaviour and sexual violence/harassment 7
    Forms of child-on-child abuse 8
    Prevention, reporting and response 8
    Nudes and semi-nudes, including AI-generated images 8
9. Online safety, AI, filtering and monitoring and mobile phones 9
    Mobile phone-free environment 9
    Artificial intelligence 9
10. Attendance, children absent from education, elective home education & alternative provision 9
    Alternative provision and off-site education 10
11. Children potentially at greater risk of harm 10
    SEND, disability and medical conditions 10
    Young carers 10
    Children with a social worker; looked-after and previously looked-after children 10
    Children who are lesbian, gay, bisexual or gender-questioning 10
    Mental health 10
12. Allegations against adults, low-level concerns and whistleblowing 11
    Concerns or allegations that may meet the harm threshold 11
    Low-level concerns 11
    DBS and Teaching Regulation Agency referrals 11
    Whistleblowing 11
13. Safer recruitment, visitors, volunteers and contractors 11
    Visitors and external speakers 12
    Recruitment information 12
14. EYFS safeguarding arrangements 12
15. Confidentiality, information sharing and safeguarding records 12
16. Curriculum, behaviour, pastoral support and pupil voice 13
17. Training, induction and safeguarding culture 13
18. Governance, monitoring, review and publication 14
19. Links with other school policies 14
Appendix A. Staff safeguarding quick guide 14
Appendix B. KCSIE 2026 / The Key compliance checklist 15

1. Purpose, vision and safeguarding principles

At St Eanswythe's we radiate God's unconditional love by being inclusive, accepting and supportive. Inspired by Jesus' commandment to 'love one another as I have loved you', we nurture every child as a valued individual and work to ensure that all pupils feel safe, heard, protected and able to flourish. Safeguarding and promoting the welfare of children is everyone's responsibility and the best interests of the child are at the heart of all decisions.

Our Christian values of Generosity, Compassion, Honesty, Forgiveness, Respect and Perseverance inform how we listen, respond, challenge harmful conduct and support recovery. Compassion and forgiveness never mean excusing abuse, delaying a referral, pressuring a child to reconcile, or replacing protective action with a restorative conversation.

- Provide a safe environment in which children can learn and flourish.
- Identify concerns early, provide appropriate support and prevent concerns escalating.
- Take timely action to protect children from maltreatment, abuse, neglect and exploitation, including harm outside the home and online.
- Maintain an attitude of "it could happen here", even where there are no reports.
- Promote an inclusive, anti-discriminatory culture in which racism, faith-targeted abuse, misogyny/misandry and other prejudice-based harm are recognised, challenged and addressed.

2. Statutory framework, definitions and scope

This policy has been reviewed against Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026, including Parts One to Five and Annexes A–C; Working Together to Safeguard Children; the Children Acts 1989 and 2004; section 175 of the Education Act 2002; the Equality Act 2010 and Public Sector Equality Duty; the Human Rights Act 1998; the Data Protection Act 2018, UK GDPR and Data (Use and Access) Act 2025; Prevent duty guidance; the current statutory Early Years Foundation Stage (EYFS) framework; and Kent Safeguarding Children Multi-Agency Partnership (KSCMP) procedures and thresholds.

St Eanswythe's is a maintained voluntary-aided primary school. Responsibilities that KCSIE places on governing bodies therefore rest with the Governing Body. This policy applies to governors, employees, volunteers, trainees, agency and supply staff, contractors and adults working with children on site, online, on educational visits, during transport, extended-school provision and activities on school premises.

Definitions

Safeguarding and promoting the welfare of children means providing help and support as soon as problems emerge; protecting children from maltreatment whether within or outside the home, including online; preventing impairment of mental and physical health or development; ensuring children grow up with safe and effective care; and taking action to enable the best outcomes. A child is anyone under 18.

Child protection is part of safeguarding and concerns action taken to protect children who are suffering, or are likely to suffer, significant harm. Abuse may be physical, emotional or sexual. Neglect is the persistent failure to meet a child's basic physical and/or psychological needs. Exploitation may be criminal, sexual, financial or otherwise and can occur online or offline.

3. Safeguarding contacts and reporting routes

Role	Name / organisation	Contact / route
DSL	Mrs Jodie Price	jprice@st-eanswythes.kent.sch.uk
Deputy DSL	Mrs Kim Adlington	kadlington@st-eanswythes.kent.sch.uk
Deputy DSL	Mrs Katy Semple	ksemple@st-eanswythes.kent.sch.uk
Deputy DSL	Mr Nicholas Brinkley	nbrinkley@st-eanswythes.kent.sch.uk
Deputy DSL	Mrs Louise Thompson	senco@st-eanswythes.kent.sch.uk
Headteacher / allegation case manager	Mrs Claire Jacobs	School office / Headteacher contact route
Chair of Governors	Mr Chris Brown	School governance contact route
Safeguarding Governor	Mrs M Coulstock	School governance contact route
Emergency	Police / ambulance	999
Kent children's services	Kent Integrated Children's Services / Front Door	Use current Kent referral portal and published contact details
Kent out of hours	Emergency Duty Team	03000 419191 – confirm before publication
Kent LADO	Local Authority Designated Officer	Use current Kent LADO referral/consultation arrangements; 03000 410888 – confirm before publication
NSPCC whistleblowing advice line	NSPCC	0800 028 0285

The school will verify all local contact details before approval and keep the staff-facing safeguarding contact sheet current. Anyone may make a direct referral to children's social care or the police. The absence of the DSL must never delay protective action.

4. Roles and responsibilities

All staff and volunteers

- Read and understand KCSIE 2026 Part One in full. The former condensed Annex A is no longer an alternative.
- Know this policy, the staff code of conduct, behaviour policy, attendance procedures, online-safety arrangements and the identity of the DSL and deputies.

- Recognise indicators of abuse, neglect and exploitation, including prejudice-based harm, domestic abuse, child-on-child abuse, criminal/sexual exploitation, radicalisation and online harm.
- Listen to children, maintain professional curiosity, record concerns factually and promptly, and report them without delay.
- Know that a child may not feel ready or able to disclose, may communicate indirectly, or may not recognise their experience as harmful.
- Understand that safeguarding information must be shared on a need-to-know basis and that data protection law does not prevent appropriate safeguarding sharing.
- Report concerns about adults, including low-level concerns, and challenge unsafe safeguarding practice.

Designated Safeguarding Lead and deputies

The DSL is a senior leader with lead responsibility for child protection and wider safeguarding. Deputies are trained to the same standard and provide robust cover, but lead responsibility is not delegated away from the DSL. The school will maintain a confidential and reliable means of contacting the safeguarding team during school operation.

- Manage referrals to children's social care, police, Channel/Prevent, DBS and other agencies as appropriate.
- Work with safeguarding partners, participate in strategy discussions and assessments, and support staff making referrals.
- Maintain and transfer child protection files; ensure records include concerns, discussions, decisions, reasons and outcomes, including decisions not to refer.
- Lead on child-on-child abuse, harmful sexual behaviour, online safety and understanding filtering and monitoring systems and processes.
- Promote a culture of listening to children, understanding barriers to disclosure and building trusted relationships.
- Support children with social workers, looked-after and previously looked-after children, young carers and children with SEND/medical needs.
- Keep the Headteacher informed as appropriate and work with the safeguarding governor on policy effectiveness.

Headteacher

The Headteacher implements this policy; ensures appropriate staffing, induction, training and safeguarding cover; acts as case manager for allegations about adults unless personally implicated; ensures low-level concerns are managed appropriately; and ensures safeguarding arrangements operate effectively across the school, EYFS, trips, clubs, visitors, contractors and third-party use of premises.

Governing Body and safeguarding governor

- Ensure safeguarding policies, procedures and training comply with law and KCSIE and are effective in practice.
- Appoint a safeguarding link governor who is not the DSL and provide appropriate challenge and oversight.
- Ensure the DSL has sufficient status, authority, time, funding, training and resources.

- Ensure safer recruitment arrangements and the single central record are accurate and effective.
- Ensure appropriate filtering and monitoring are in place; review the DfE filtering and monitoring standards and discuss requirements with IT staff/providers.
- Ensure the school has procedures for allegations and low-level concerns, DBS/TRA referrals where criteria are met, and third-party use of school premises.
- Ensure governors receive safeguarding training at induction and that it is regularly updated.

5. Recognising abuse, neglect, exploitation and additional vulnerabilities

Safeguarding issues often overlap. Harm may occur within or outside the home, at school, in the community or online, and may be caused by adults or other children. Staff must be alert to physical abuse, emotional abuse (including verbal abuse such as criticism, belittling and name-calling), sexual abuse, neglect, domestic abuse, child criminal exploitation (CCE), child sexual exploitation (CSE), modern slavery, county lines, serious violence, radicalisation, forced marriage, female genital mutilation (FGM), financial exploitation, stalking, bullying, discrimination and harmful sexual behaviour.

Mental health problems can be an indicator that a child has suffered or is at risk of abuse, neglect or exploitation. Staff are not expected to diagnose; safeguarding concerns must be referred to the DSL. A child's behaviour, attendance, injuries or distress must not automatically be attributed to SEND, disability or a medical condition.

Children who may be disproportionately vulnerable

- children with SEND, disabilities or medical/physical health conditions;
- young carers;
- children with a social worker, looked-after and previously looked-after children;
- children who experience racism, faith-based prejudice, homophobic/biphobic/transphobic bullying or other discrimination;
- children who are absent repeatedly or for prolonged periods, missing education, suspended repeatedly or on reduced timetables;
- children affected by domestic abuse, parental conflict, parental imprisonment/offending, substance misuse, mental ill health, housing instability or homelessness;
- children at risk of exploitation, trafficking, modern slavery, serious violence, forced marriage, FGM or radicalisation;
- children who face language, communication or other barriers to seeking help.

6. Responding to concerns and disclosures

- If a child is in immediate danger or needs emergency medical help, call 999, secure immediate safety and inform the DSL as soon as possible.

- Listen calmly and take the child seriously. Reassure them that they have done the right thing by telling you and that they are not creating a problem.
- Do not investigate, ask leading questions, ask a child to repeat their account unnecessarily, or promise secrecy or a particular outcome.
- Explain that information will be shared only with people who need it in order to help keep them safe.
- Make a prompt, dated and factual record, using the child's own words where possible and distinguishing fact, observation and professional judgement.
- Speak to the DSL/deputy immediately. If unavailable, this must not delay action: seek senior-leader or children's social care advice and make a direct referral where necessary.
- Do not seek parental permission where doing so could place the child at greater risk or compromise an investigation.

Female genital mutilation

A teacher who is informed by a girl under 18 that FGM has been carried out on her, or observes physical signs that appear to show FGM has been carried out and has no reason to believe it was necessary for health or birth-related reasons, has a personal statutory duty to report this to the police. Staff must also follow school safeguarding procedures. No member of staff should examine a pupil to determine whether FGM has occurred.

7. Family Help, referrals, multi-agency working and escalation

Staff should be prepared to identify children who may benefit from universal services, community-based Early Help or the targeted early help level of Family Help. The school follows current Kent criteria and local assessment protocols. Family Help is not a substitute for referral where there is reasonable cause to suspect that a child is suffering or likely to suffer significant harm.

The DSL will normally coordinate support and referrals, but any staff member may refer directly. Staff should expect to support children's social care and other agencies after referral. The referrer should check that children's social care has acknowledged the referral and communicated next steps within one working day; if not, follow up. If the child's circumstances do not improve, re-refer and/or use Kent escalation procedures. Record the referral, rationale, response, follow-up and outcome.

The school works within arrangements made by the three safeguarding partners: the local authority, the integrated care board and the chief officer of police. Relevant information will be shared promptly and proportionately with these partners and other practitioners.

8. Child-on-child abuse, harmful sexual behaviour and sexual violence/harassment

St Eanswythe's adopts a zero-tolerance approach to child-on-child abuse. It will never be dismissed as "banter", "just having a laugh", "part of growing up" or "boys being boys". Even where there are no

reported cases, staff must recognise that abuse may still be occurring and not being reported. For some, but not all, forms of child-on-child abuse, girls are more likely to be victims and boys perpetrators; all child-on-child abuse is unacceptable and will be taken seriously.

Forms of child-on-child abuse

- bullying, including cyberbullying, prejudice-based and discriminatory bullying;
- racism, faith-targeted abuse and other discriminatory behaviour;
- abuse in intimate personal relationships between children;
- physical abuse and assault, including hitting, kicking, shaking, biting, hair pulling, or threats/harm involving a weapon;
- harmful sexual behaviour, sexual violence and sexual harassment, including misogyny/misandry;
- consensual and non-consensual making or sharing of nudes and semi-nudes, including AI-generated imagery;
- causing someone to engage in sexual activity without consent;
- upskirting;
- initiation/hazing-type violence and rituals.

Prevention, reporting and response

The school minimises risk through a safe culture, supervision, age-appropriate RSHE/PSHE, online-safety education, clear behaviour expectations, staff training, accessible reporting routes and prompt challenge of sexualised, racist, faith-targeted, discriminatory or violent behaviour. Children are taught that they can speak to any trusted adult; reporting routes are promoted, easily understood and accessible.

All allegations are recorded and reported to the DSL. Staff must not investigate independently. The DSL will consider immediate safety, an ongoing risk assessment, supervision/separation where necessary, trusted adults, educational and pastoral support, parent/carer involvement where safe, and referrals to children's social care/police. The needs of the child harmed, the child alleged to have caused harm, witnesses and siblings will be considered. A child displaying harmful behaviour may also be a child in need of protection.

The school may take disciplinary action while external investigations are ongoing only where this will not prejudice police or social-care enquiries. Restorative approaches may support recovery only where safe, voluntary, developmentally appropriate and consistent with specialist advice. No child will be required to meet, forgive or reconcile with someone who harmed them.

Nudes and semi-nudes, including AI-generated images

Staff must not request, copy, print, forward, save, circulate or delete imagery, or ask a child to send it to them. Staff should not view imagery unless the DSL determines that viewing is necessary and proportionate in line with current UKCIS guidance. If imagery is inadvertently viewed, report this immediately. The DSL will assess coercion, age, consent, distribution and risk and seek police/social-care advice where required.

9. Online safety, AI, filtering and monitoring and mobile phones

Online safety is a running and interrelated theme of safeguarding. The school addresses the four categories of online risk: content, contact, conduct and commerce. This includes risks from generative AI, misinformation/disinformation, grooming, explicit or AI-generated sexual imagery, cyberbullying, radicalisation, scams and financial exploitation.

The DSL has lead safeguarding responsibility for online safety and understanding the filtering and monitoring systems and processes. The SLT member responsible for filtering and monitoring, supported by the DSL and IT support, will ensure the effectiveness of filtering and monitoring is reviewed at least once each academic year, including checks that filtering works on internet-connected devices in relevant locations, with records retained. Significant incidents or changes will prompt additional review.

The Governing Body ensures appropriate systems are in place, reviews the DfE filtering and monitoring standards and discusses with IT staff/providers what is needed to meet them. Technical controls do not replace supervision, education or reporting.

Mobile phone-free environment

In line with KCSIE 2026, St Eanswythe's operates as a mobile phone-free environment for pupils by default. Pupils must not have access to personal mobile phones during the school day, including lessons, transitions, breaktimes and lunchtimes, except where the Headteacher has authorised a specific exception for an individual need. The school's behaviour/acceptable-use arrangements set out how devices brought to school are stored and managed. Staff personal-device use is governed by the staff code of conduct and EYFS requirements.

Artificial intelligence

The school recognises both the educational value and safeguarding risks of generative AI. New tools are risk assessed before use. Staff must not enter identifiable child protection or confidential pupil information into unapproved AI services. AI-generated sexual imagery, deepfakes, impersonation, grooming, discriminatory content and disclosure of personal data are treated as safeguarding risks.

10. Attendance, children absent from education, elective home education and alternative provision

Repeated or prolonged absence, unexplained non-attendance and children missing education can be warning signs of abuse, neglect, exploitation or unmet need. Attendance staff and the DSL review patterns together, follow up promptly and make referrals under local procedures where indicated. The school will, where reasonably possible, hold more than one emergency contact number for each pupil.

Where a parent indicates an intention to electively home educate, safeguarding information and known vulnerabilities will be considered and statutory notification procedures followed. The school will work with the local authority where there are safeguarding concerns.

Alternative provision and off-site education

Where the school places a pupil in alternative provision, it remains responsible for the safeguarding of that pupil. The school will satisfy itself that the placement has appropriate safeguarding arrangements, obtain assurance about relevant checks, agree information-sharing and attendance arrangements, maintain oversight of the pupil's welfare and progress, and act on any concern. Safeguarding information will be shared with the provider on a need-to-know basis.

11. Children potentially at greater risk of harm

SEND, disability and medical conditions

Children with SEND, disabilities or medical/physical health conditions can face additional safeguarding barriers, including assumptions that behaviour, mood or injury relates to their condition; greater risk of isolation or bullying; disproportionate impact of harmful behaviour; communication barriers; and difficulty understanding online content or consequences. Staff must explore concerns rather than attribute them automatically to a child's needs. The DSL will liaise closely with the SENCo and relevant medical professionals.

Young carers

Young carers may have additional responsibilities and pressures that affect attendance, wellbeing and access to support. Staff should identify needs early and coordinate appropriate support without making assumptions about family circumstances.

Children with a social worker; looked-after and previously looked-after children

The DSL will use information from social workers to inform decisions about safety, education and support. The designated teacher and DSL will work together for looked-after and previously looked-after children and liaise with the Virtual School Head and relevant agencies as appropriate.

Children who are lesbian, gay, bisexual or gender-questioning

Children who are LGB or perceived to be LGB may be targeted by peers. Gender-questioning children may also be vulnerable to bullying or other harm. Staff will provide a safe space to speak, respond to safeguarding concerns, protect privacy and dignity, and follow current statutory guidance and school arrangements. Safeguarding decisions will be child-centred and recorded appropriately.

Mental health

Where a mental-health concern is also a safeguarding concern, staff must follow safeguarding procedures immediately. School pastoral support and external mental-health support supplement, but do not replace, child-protection action.

12. Allegations against adults, low-level concerns and whistleblowing

Concerns or allegations that may meet the harm threshold

Any concern that an adult working with children, including a supply teacher, trainee teacher, volunteer or contractor, has harmed or may have harmed a child; may have committed a criminal offence against or related to a child; behaved towards a child in a way indicating they may pose a risk of harm; or behaved in a way that may indicate they are unsuitable to work with children, must be reported without delay to the Headteacher as case manager. Concerns about the Headteacher go to the Chair of Governors. Where there is a conflict of interest, contact the LADO directly.

The case manager will consider immediate safety and contact the LADO in line with local procedures before investigating. The school will follow additional KCSIE procedures for supply teachers, agency staff and contracted staff and will work with the employer/agency. If an allegation relates to an individual or organisation using school premises for an activity involving children, the school will follow its safeguarding procedures and inform the LADO as appropriate.

Low-level concerns

A low-level concern is any concern, no matter how small, that an adult may have acted in a way inconsistent with the staff code of conduct, including inappropriate conduct outside work, even where the harm threshold is not met. Concerns must be reported promptly, recorded confidentially and reviewed for patterns. The Headteacher normally manages low-level concerns; an alternative case manager is used where the Headteacher is implicated.

DBS and Teaching Regulation Agency referrals

The school will make a referral to the Disclosure and Barring Service where the legal criteria are met, including where a person in regulated activity is removed because of safeguarding concerns or would have been removed had they not left. Where a teacher is dismissed or would have been dismissed for serious misconduct, the school will consider referral to the Secretary of State via the Teaching Regulation Agency in accordance with KCSIE.

Whistleblowing

Staff must raise concerns about poor or unsafe safeguarding practice through the school's whistleblowing procedures. Where internal routes are inappropriate or concerns remain, external advice may be sought, including from the NSPCC whistleblowing advice line.

13. Safer recruitment, visitors, volunteers and contractors

The school adopts recruitment procedures designed to deter and prevent unsuitable people from obtaining employment or volunteering opportunities. At least one member of each recruitment panel will have completed appropriate safer-recruitment training. Recruitment follows KCSIE Part Three and includes identity, right-to-work, qualifications, employment history and references, enhanced DBS and barred-list checks where required, prohibition checks where applicable, overseas checks where

relevant, and childcare disqualification requirements for applicable roles. Online searches may be undertaken on shortlisted candidates in line with KCSIE and recruitment procedures.

The school maintains an accurate Single Central Record. From 2026, changes to regulated activity for volunteers are applied in accordance with the Crime and Policing Act 2026 and KCSIE. Appropriate checks and supervision arrangements are applied to volunteers, contractors, agency/supply personnel and governors.

Visitors and external speakers

Visitors are managed proportionately according to their purpose and likely contact with children. Professional visitors will have identity checked and the school will obtain assurance that appropriate DBS checks have been completed where required; the school will not routinely request DBS certificates from visitors where KCSIE says this is unnecessary. The Headteacher or delegated leader will decide whether escort or supervision is required.

For external organisations, speakers and performers, the school will consider suitability, educational value, age appropriateness, safeguarding risks and whether relevant checks or supervision are required. Visitor sign-in, identification and safeguarding information will be used in line with school procedures.

Recruitment information

A copy of, or link to, this child protection and safeguarding policy will be included in application packs for school vacancies. Safer recruitment expectations are reflected in recruitment documentation and processes.

14. EYFS safeguarding arrangements

Reception provision is subject to the safeguarding and welfare requirements of the current statutory EYFS framework as well as KCSIE. The Headteacher ensures required staffing ratios, suitable staff, a key person where applicable, appropriate supervision and safe use of premises and equipment. Staff remain alert to the safeguarding needs of young children, including children who are non-verbal or pre-verbal.

Personal mobile phones and personal cameras must not be used to photograph or record children. School devices are used only in accordance with authorised procedures. Staff, visitors and volunteers follow the school's EYFS arrangements for mobile phones, cameras and other recording devices. Any safeguarding concern arising from technology use is reported immediately to the DSL.

15. Confidentiality, information sharing and safeguarding records

Safeguarding information is confidential but not secret. Staff must never promise a child absolute confidentiality. Information is shared only with those who need it to safeguard the child. Data

protection law, including the Data Protection Act 2018, UK GDPR and Data (Use and Access) Act 2025, does not prevent the sharing of information for safeguarding purposes where there is a lawful basis.

Records must be detailed, accurate, secure and separate from the main pupil file, and include concerns, disclosures, discussions, decisions, reasons, referrals, outcomes and instances where a referral was considered but not made. Access is limited to authorised staff. The DSL ensures continuity and auditability.

When a child leaves, the child-protection file will be transferred securely to the new school or college as soon as possible and separately from the main pupil file, in accordance with KCSIE. Receipt will be confirmed. The DSL will consider whether it is appropriate to share information in advance to support transition and safety.

Parents/carers will normally be informed and involved unless doing so would increase risk, compromise an investigation or conflict with advice from children's social care or police. Staff must consult the DSL before contacting families about a disclosure or allegation.

16. Curriculum, behaviour, pastoral support and pupil voice

Safeguarding is taught through age-appropriate PSHE/RSHE, online safety, relationships, boundaries and consent, discrimination and prejudice, personal safety, healthy relationships and help-seeking. Teaching is adapted to the needs and vulnerabilities of pupils, including SEND. External materials and visitors are checked for suitability and age appropriateness.

The school's relational and restorative behaviour approach, anti-bullying arrangements and pastoral support work alongside this policy, never instead of it. Soft Landing and other pastoral provision can support regulation and trusted relationships but do not replace referrals or protective action.

Children are taught how to identify trusted adults and report concerns. Reporting systems are well promoted, easily understood and accessible. Children's wishes and feelings are considered when deciding what action and support are appropriate, while adults retain responsibility for safeguarding decisions.

17. Training, induction and safeguarding culture

All staff receive safeguarding and child-protection training, including online safety and filtering/monitoring responsibilities, at induction. Training is regularly updated and staff receive safeguarding updates as required and at least annually. Staff are given this policy, Part One of KCSIE 2026, the staff code of conduct, behaviour policy, attendance procedures and details of the DSL/deputies at induction.

The DSL and deputy DSLs undertake formal role-specific safeguarding training at least every two years. In addition, their knowledge and skills are refreshed at regular intervals and at least annually. Governors receive safeguarding training at induction and regular updates sufficient to provide strategic challenge and assurance.

Temporary staff, volunteers and contractors receive safeguarding information proportionate to their role and level of contact with children. Staff are encouraged to contribute to and shape safeguarding policy and arrangements and to raise concerns where systems are not working effectively.

18. Governance, monitoring, review and publication

The Governing Body reviews this policy at least annually and updates it sooner where needed to reflect emerging safeguarding issues, lessons learned, changes in statutory/local guidance or changes in school practice. The DSL works with the Headteacher and Governing Body to review implementation and effectiveness, not merely the existence of procedures.

The policy is published on the school website and is available to pupils, parents/carers and staff in an accessible form. It is provided to and followed by all staff, explained to new staff at induction and made accessible to part-time staff. A copy or link is included in application packs for school vacancies.

Safeguarding monitoring includes appropriate assurance on referrals and escalation, pupil voice, attendance concerns, children with additional vulnerabilities, allegations/low-level concerns, safer recruitment and the SCR, training, online safety and filtering/monitoring, alternative provision, third-party use of premises and actions arising from audits or incidents.

19. Links with other school policies

- Behaviour Policy
- Staff Code of Conduct / Staff Behaviour Policy
- Whistleblowing Policy
- Online Safety / Acceptable Use Policy
- Attendance Policy and procedures for children absent from education
- Anti-bullying arrangements
- SEND Policy and Accessibility Plan
- RSHE/PSHE Policy
- Safer Recruitment procedures
- Complaints Policy
- Data Protection / Privacy and Records Retention arrangements
- Health and Safety Policy
- Educational Visits procedures
- Intimate Care / Physical Intervention and Reasonable Force procedures
- EYFS policies and procedures

Appendix A. Staff safeguarding quick guide

Situation	What to do
Immediate danger	Call 999; take immediate protective action; inform the DSL as soon as possible.
A child tells you something worrying	Listen, reassure, do not promise secrecy or investigate; record the child's words and tell the DSL immediately.
DSL unavailable	Speak to a deputy/senior leader or children's social care; refer directly where needed; do not delay.
Child-on-child concern	Protect all children; report to DSL; preserve evidence; do not investigate or force a restorative meeting.
Concern about an adult	Report to Headteacher; about Headteacher to Chair of Governors; conflict of interest to LADO.
Nude/semi-nude imagery	Do not request, copy, forward, save, circulate or delete; report immediately to DSL.
FGM disclosed/observed by teacher	Teacher personally reports to police where the statutory duty applies and also follows school safeguarding procedures.
After a referral	Check response, record decisions and rationale, monitor and escalate/re-refer if risk persists.

Appendix B. KCSIE 2026 / The Key compliance checklist

This appendix records the areas checked against the July 2026 The Key child protection policy checklist and KCSIE 2026. It is for annual review and Governing Body assurance.

Checklist area	Status	Where covered
Child-on-child abuse	**Covered**	Covered in section 8: prevention, accessible reporting, recording/response, support for all affected children, zero tolerance, gendered patterns and forms of abuse.
SEND / medical conditions	**Covered**	Covered in sections 5 and 11, including additional barriers and avoiding diagnostic overshadowing.
Children more at risk of harm	**Covered**	Integrated through sections 5 and 11, including discrimination and online/offline vulnerability.
Reporting systems / multi-agency working	**Covered**	Covered in sections 3, 6, 7 and 16; includes local Kent arrangements and direct-referral rights.

Checklist area	Status	Where covered
Visitors	**Covered**	Covered in section 13, including professional visitors, external speakers, age appropriateness, checks and supervision.
Roles and responsibilities	**Covered**	Covered in section 4 for staff, DSL/deputies, Headteacher, safeguarding governor and Governing Body.
Training and induction	**Covered**	Covered in section 17; DSL/deputies at least every two years plus annual knowledge/skills updates; staff induction and annual updates.
Online safety / filtering / monitoring	**Covered**	Covered in section 9; DSL and Governing Body responsibilities, annual effectiveness review and DfE standards.
Mobile phone-free approach	**Covered**	Covered in section 9; pupil access prohibited throughout the school day by default, with authorised exceptions only.
Safer recruitment	**Covered**	Covered in section 13, including SCR, checks, volunteers, contractors and recruitment-pack policy link.
Recognising abuse and taking action	**Covered**	Covered in sections 5–7, including direct referrals, FGM and escalation.
Allegations / low-level concerns	**Covered**	Covered in section 12, including supply/contracted staff, premises users, LADO, DBS and TRA referrals.
Information sharing	**Covered**	Covered in section 15, including Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 and detailed record-keeping.
EYFS	**Covered**	Covered in section 14, including mobile phones and cameras.
Monitoring and sharing policy	**Covered**	Covered in section 18: annual review, website publication, induction, staff access and recruitment packs.

Local checks required before Governing Body approval

- Confirm current Kent Front Door, out-of-hours, LADO and escalation contact details.
- Confirm the school's current safeguarding recording system and retention schedule.
- Confirm the named filtering/monitoring products and operational check frequency; keep these in staff-facing procedures if products may change.

- Confirm the precise pupil mobile-phone storage/collection arrangements and any authorised exceptions.
- Confirm visitor sign-in/supervision procedures and alternative-provision assurance processes.
- Insert approval/effective/review dates and publish the final approved policy.